

NORTHWESTERN MEMORIAL HOSPITAL

Department of Orthopedics & Spine Care

Patient Name: Patricia Lee	DOB: 11/20/1974 (Age 51)
Patient ID: p-008	Member ID: UHC-1111-008 (Non-Medicare)
Requesting Physician: Dr. Sarah Jenkins, MD	NPI: 1234567890
Policy ID: MRI-69575638	Policy Name: Lumbar Spine MRI Criteria
Procedure Requested: CPT 72148 (Lumbar MRI w/o Contrast)	Primary Diagnosis: M54.50 Low Back Pain

CLINICAL EVALUATION NOTE — LUMBAR SPINE MRI REQUEST

History of Present Illness:
Patient is a 51-year-old female presenting with acute non-radiating low back pain (ICD-10 M54.50) of **2 weeks duration** following heavy lifting at home. Pain is localized to the lumbosacral region without radiation to the lower extremities.

Physical Examination & Neurological Assessment:
Physical examination reveals mild paraspinal muscle tenderness. Range of motion of the lumbar spine is mildly restricted by discomfort. Bilateral lower extremity motor strength is intact at 5/5 in all muscle groups. Deep tendon reflexes (patellar and Achilles) are 2+ equal bilaterally. Sensation to light touch and pinprick is intact in L1 through S1 dermatomes. Straight leg raise test is negative bilaterally.

Red Flag Screening (All Absent):
Negative for progressive neurological deficits, negative for saddle anesthesia or bowel/bladder dysfunction (no cauda equina syndrome), no fever or history of IV drug use, no history of malignancy or unexplained weight loss, and no history of severe trauma or osteoporosis.

Conservative Therapy & Physical Therapy Status:
Patient has taken over-the-counter Ibuprofen intermittently for 10 days. **No formal physical therapy evaluation or structured conservative therapy program has been completed to date** (0 weeks physical therapy completed). Requesting lumbar spine MRI (CPT 72148) prior to initiating physical therapy.

Attending Physician: Dr. Sarah Jenkins, MD

Signature: S. Jenkins, MD

Date: August 24, 2026

License #: MD-361234-IL